

# Rider-First Brief v2: Motorcycle Accessories Website

Frontend experience + the backend systems that keep it honest

*This isn't a checklist of screens. It's what I, as a rider, actually think about when I open a bike accessories site on my phone trying to decide if a part fits my bike — plus the operational systems that have to work behind the scenes for that promise to stay true.*

## 1. The Rider's Mindset

- I want fit certainty before I scroll, not after I read specs
- I don't trust product photos alone — I want to see it installed on a real bike
- I'm usually browsing one-handed on my phone, often standing near my bike
- I already know "genuine vs local part" anxiety — the site has to earn trust fast
- I want to reorder consumables without re-searching every time

## 2. What the Site Must Solve

### A. Fit confidence — and the data that has to stay accurate behind it

- Bike selector (make → model → year → variant) pinned near the top nav
- Every product page opens with a clear "Fits your [bike]" or "Not compatible" badge
- "My Garage" saves bikes so returning visitors skip re-selecting

The compatibility data behind this badge is the actual product, not a feature — get this wrong once and the whole trust model collapses. It needs to be treated as structured, owned, and versioned data, not a static spec sheet:

- Model a compatibility table, not free text: brand → base model → year range → variant/trim → region, each linked to specific SKUs, so facelifts and regional variants are separate rows, not edits that overwrite history
- Distinguish "OEM fit" (verified against factory spec) from "universal fit" (fits most, not guaranteed) — show this distinction on the badge itself, not just in fine print
- For aftermarket frames or heavily modified bikes: an honest "fit not guaranteed for modified bikes — confirm before ordering" flag instead of a false-confidence badge
- A customer-facing "this didn't fit my bike" report button on every order — this is the fastest, cheapest way to catch bad compatibility data, and it should route straight to a review queue, not disappear into support email
- A recurring internal process (not just a one-time data entry): new bike launches and facelifts get scheduled into the catalog update process, and flagged mismatches get reviewed on a set cadence, not ad hoc

### B. Trust — including a real plan for where the proof comes from

- Authenticity markers on every product: brand logo, "Genuine Part" badge, warranty period
- Reviews filtered to show riders with your exact bike first

"Real install photos" is the right idea, but it doesn't fill itself — it needs a supply plan or the section sits empty and undermines the trust it's meant to build:

- Seed every product page at launch with brand/vendor-supplied install photos, clearly labelled "Official install photo" so the page is never empty on day one
- Prompt customers automatically 5–7 days after delivery (email/SMS/app) to upload a photo or short review, with a small incentive — loyalty points, a discount code on next order, or entry into a monthly draw
- Route all customer uploads through a light moderation queue before publishing (clear quality, product visible, no abuse) — this can be a single admin screen, doesn't need to be complex

- Show a simple counter ("14 riders installed this") once submissions exist — social proof compounds once it starts moving

Return policy for fitment mismatches needs to live on the product page itself, short and specific — not buried in a help article the rider has to go looking for:

- One line directly below price / near Add to Cart, e.g. "Free return within 7 days if it doesn't fit your bike"
- Tapping it opens a short inline modal with the actual terms — no navigation away from the product page

### C. My Garage — concrete interaction design, not just "save a bike"

- Garage shown as a horizontal switcher (cards or chips) at the top of the site — tapping a bike sets it as the active context everywhere
- Each bike card shows: nickname/model, small photo, and quick actions to edit or remove (swipe or long-press on mobile)
- Add-bike flow is a short guided sequence: brand → model → year/variant, with autocomplete so it's fast on a phone keyboard
- Each bike's card links to "Orders for this bike" so a rider with two bikes never has to guess what they bought for which
- If multiple bikes are saved, one is marked primary/default and loads automatically on return visits

### D. Feels like it's made for riders, not just a store

- Bundles that make sense to a rider — "Monsoon Riding Kit," "First Service Essentials"
- Maintenance tips and install guides tied to products, not generic blog filler
- Copy that sounds like a fellow rider — direct, confident, no corporate fluff

## 3. Visual Identity (Red / Black / White / Grey)

| Token                | Hex     | Usage                                       |
|----------------------|---------|---------------------------------------------|
| --color-bg           | #FFFFFF | Primary background                          |
| --color-surface      | #F7F7F8 | Cards, filter panels, section backgrounds   |
| --color-ink          | #0D0D0D | Headlines, nav, primary text                |
| --color-ink-muted    | #6E6E73 | Secondary text, specs, captions             |
| --color-accent       | #D62828 | CTAs, price, "Fits your bike" badge, alerts |
| --color-accent-dark  | #A31E1E | Hover/pressed state for accent              |
| --color-border       | #E2E2E4 | Dividers, input borders                     |
| --color-dark-surface | #111111 | Footer, dark-mode base, hero overlay        |

Ratio guide: ~70% white/light-grey, ~20% black text/structure, ~10% red for things needing attention only. Never a full red section.

## 4. Pages Needed

| Page               | Rider need it solves                                                           |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Homepage           | Bike selector, quick reorder, trust signals                                    |
| Category / Listing | Instant filters, compatibility badge on every card                             |
| Product Detail     | Fit badge, install photos, verified-bike reviews, fitment return policy inline |

|                 |                                                           |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| My Garage       | Multi-bike switching, per-bike order history              |
| Cart / Checkout | Fast, minimal steps, COD + card, clear totals             |
| Order Tracking  | Peace of mind after purchase                              |
| Reviews         | Filterable by exact bike model                            |
| Help / Returns  | Full policy detail (product page shows the short version) |
| Blog / Guides   | Maintenance tips, install guides, seasonal content        |

## 5. Backend CMS / Admin Panel (client self-manages everything)

The client needs to run the site day-to-day without touching code. Build a separate admin app (role-based login) alongside the customer-facing site — this is a required deliverable, not an add-on.

### Must-have admin modules

- Product management — add/edit products, pricing, stock, images, categories, bundles
- Compatibility manager — a structured table editor for the fitment data from Section 2A: add/edit brand → model → year → variant → SKU links, with bulk CSV import/export (this is the highest-value admin screen — protect it with an audit log of who changed what and when)
- Order management — view/update order status, trigger tracking updates, process returns/refunds
- Reviews & UGC moderation — approve/reject customer photos and reviews before they go live
- Offers & banners — create/schedule discount codes and homepage banners without a code deploy
- Blog/content editor — publish maintenance guides and posts (simple rich-text editor, no markup needed)
- Customer support tools — view a customer's orders, garage, and open "didn't fit" reports in one place
- Basic roles — e.g. Admin (full access), Catalog Manager (products + compatibility only), Support (orders + reviews only)

### Build approach

- Fastest path: a headless CMS (Strapi or Sanity) for products/content/blog, with a custom admin screen just for the compatibility table and order management — those two are too specific to fit a generic CMS well
- Alternative: a fully custom admin dashboard (e.g. Next.js + a database like PostgreSQL) if the compatibility manager and order workflows need to stay tightly connected to the storefront's fit-checking logic
- Either way: forms and tables for the client, never a code editor — everything editable through buttons, dropdowns, and file uploads

## 6. Instructions for the AI Coding Assistant

- Build in this order: compatibility data model + admin compatibility manager first, then the bike selector and fit-badge logic, then the component library, then full pages
- Mobile-first for the storefront; the admin panel can be desktop-first since staff will use it on larger screens
- Use realistic mock data (real bike brands/models) so fit-checking and the admin compatibility editor can both be tested end-to-end
- Keep storefront copy short and rider-toned; admin panel copy can be plain and functional

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Bottom line: the storefront earns trust in the moment; the admin panel and data process are what keep that trust true six months later when new bikes launch and old promises still need to hold.